

BCI Python environment setup

Install the course environment once, then activate it whenever you work on an assignment.

First-time setup

1. Install [Anaconda](#) if Conda is not already installed. If Conda already works on your computer, keep your existing installation.
2. Download `bci-BKI323_python-env.zip` from Brightspace and extract the ZIP file. The extracted folder must contain `environment.yml`.
3. Open the prompt provided with your Conda installation. With Anaconda, use the **Anaconda Prompt** on Windows; on macOS or Linux, use a **terminal**. Use `cd` to navigate to the extracted `bci-BKI323_python-env` folder.
4. Create the complete environment:

```
conda env create -f environment.yml
```

Keep the prompt open until the command finishes. The first installation is a large download and may take a while.

5. Before starting Jupyter, use `cd` to navigate to the folder containing the assignment notebook. You may activate the environment before or after changing folders. Then run:

```
conda activate bci-BKI323
jupyter notebook
```

Open the assignment notebook from the Jupyter page that appears in your browser.

Every later session

Open the prompt or terminal and navigate to the folder containing the assignment notebook. Activate the environment before or after changing folders, then start Jupyter:

```
conda activate bci-BKI323
jupyter notebook
```

The environment contains all Python packages needed for Assignments 1–13. Some assignments require datasets that are downloaded or provided separately.

CPU-only PyTorch is included; no GPU setup is needed.

If setup fails

If Conda cannot find `environment.yml`, navigate to the extracted environment folder and try again. For any other error, copy the complete error message when asking the course staff for help. On Windows, use the prompt provided with your Conda installation; with Anaconda, use the Anaconda Prompt.